

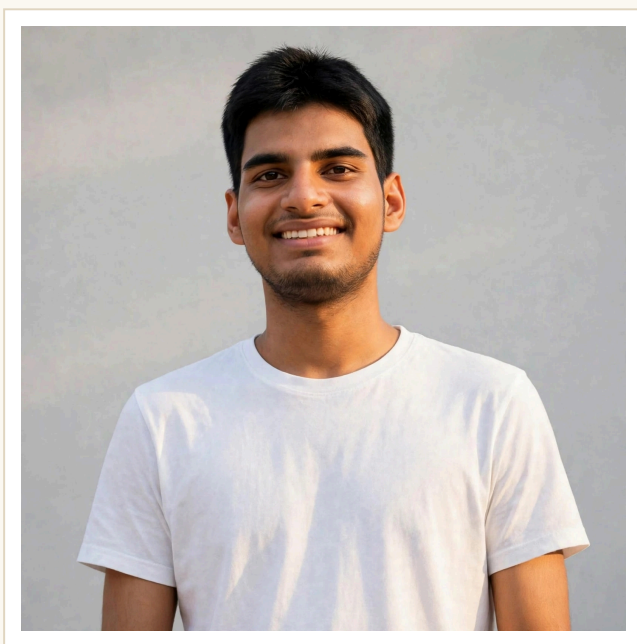
A BOY WHO NEVER THOUGHT

Safar Se Safar Tak

AN AUTOBIOGRAPHY

RAVI RAJ SINGH

A Boy Who Never Thought



Ravi Raj Singh
Patna, India · 2026



A Book by

A Boy Who Never Thought

Safar Se Safar Tak

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Ravi Raj Singh

Patna, India · 2026

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First written in 2024. Ongoing.

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To my parents, who gave me the courage to dream.

To my sisters, who taught me patience.

To the friends who stayed.



— Ravi Raj Singh

Author's Note

This book is not fiction. Every name, every date, every memory is real. I wrote it for my parents, my sisters, and for the boy I used to be.

Some memories are painful. Some are joyful. All of them are mine.

I have tried to be honest. I have tried to remember things exactly as they happened — though memory, like everything, fades with time.

If you find yourself in these pages, know that you mattered. You still do.

— Ravi Raj Singh

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How to Read This Book

This is a memoir — a true story of a boy growing up in Begusarai, Bihar. It covers the years 2008 to 2026, across eighteen chapters.

You can read it in order, or begin anywhere. Each chapter is a self-contained memory. The Hinglish edition is available alongside the English.

The story continues. It is still being written.



Begin anywhere. Read slowly.

This story belongs to you now.

CHAPTER ONE

The Beginning

2008



2008, March. Bandwar¹. Night.

There was no doctor at the hospital. So Mummy was taken to Seema aunty²'s house. A small room in someone else's home, where a new life was about to enter the world.

A female gynecologist came. She went to Dadi³. She said — "*Chachi, pota hua hai.*"

In our village dialect. In that flat tone. The way news travels from one house to another in a small town.

Dadi called Papa. Papa was out.

He said nothing.

He just went quiet.

Mummy says Papa's face was different that night. His gaze was different. Maybe he was thinking something. Maybe he wasn't understanding something. Or maybe both.

But he held me.

Late.

With love.

I don't remember any of this. I was 11 months old when Dadi passed away. And to this day, I don't know if Dadi ever held me. A question that will stay in my heart forever — a woman who heard the news of my birth first, did she ever touch me?

Mummy told me all this. In 2024. When I was in 10th.

By then I was 16. And I didn't know the story of my own birth.

Because when I was born — for 6 days, I had no name.

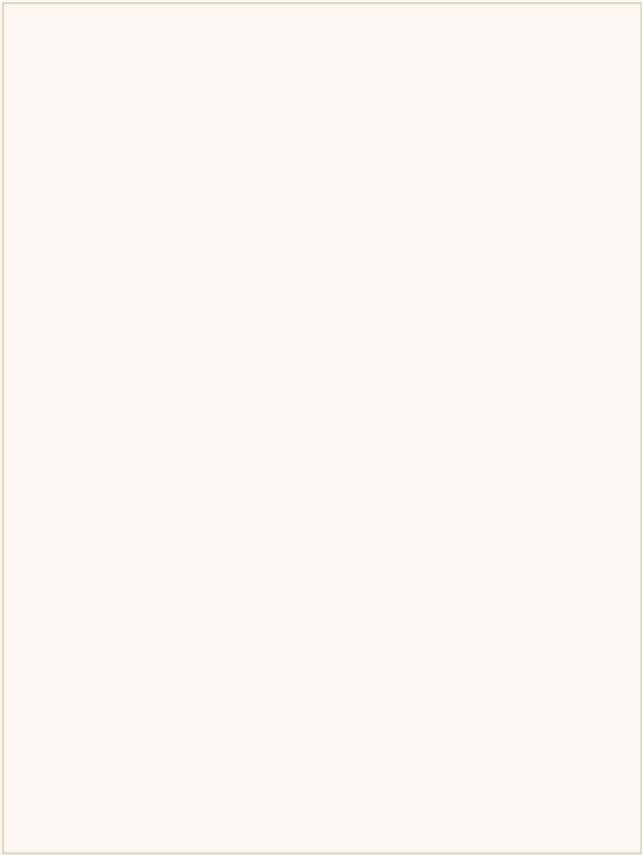


Fig. 1.1 – Childhood photograph, 2008

On the 6th day, the naming ceremony happened.

Pandit ji⁴ came. Sat down. Read the horoscope. Then said — *"Name him with 'N'. It will be auspicious."*

Nishant. Chinmay. Naman. Suggestions started coming.

But Mummy stayed silent.

Then she said — *"It will be with 'R'."*

Pandit ji said 'N'. Mummy said 'R'.

Because Mummy's name is Rajani. And she felt — naming a child with the same letter as the mother is a good thing.

No one agreed at first. People said — *"Nishant is good. Pandit ji has said so."*

But Mummy didn't budge.

It will be 'R'.

Then which name with 'R'? Ravi? Rahul? Raj? Rohit? Nothing was decided.

Days passed like this.

Pandit ji left saying 'N'. Mummy stayed stuck on 'R'. And in between, there was someone who wasn't deciding anything.

People started calling me.

Not by a name.

By a sweet little name.

Ghantee⁵.

Mummy says — I used to cry a lot.

All night. Loud. No one could quiet me.

One night, the neighbour bhaiya came. He heard my voice from outside the house.

He came in. Looked at me. Then said —

"Arre, this one's a little bell. Always ringing."

Everyone laughed.

Mummy too.

Papa too.

Maybe I forgot to cry that night.

After that, everyone started calling me by that name.

Mummy.

Papa.

Dadi.

Nani⁶.

Neighbours.

The whole town.

Everyone.

A name did come later. Suraj. Ravi Raj. But until then, everyone called me Ghantee.

Mummy says — when I cried too much, she would turn into a ghost to scare me.

"*Bhoot⁷ aa gaya! Bhoot aa gaya!*"

And I would go quiet out of fear.

Then the same Mummy, the same ghost, would sit me in her lap and feed me milk.

Fear and love.

The same woman.

The same night.

I don't remember anything about that night.

But Mummy didn't sleep.

Seema aunty had fallen asleep. Papa sat outside, silent. Only Mummy was awake — looking at me.

A boy without a name.

NOTES

- ¹ A village in Begusarai district, Bihar
- ² A neighbour who gave Mummy a room for the delivery
- ³ Paternal grandmother
- ⁴ A Hindu priest
- ⁵ Ravi Raj's affectionate nickname
- ⁶ Maternal grandmother
- ⁷ Ghost — used playfully to scare the child

CHAPTER TWO

A Loss

2009



Papa told me — 12 January 2009. Afternoon.

He was in the field. Between the crops. It was a full day's work. The sun was harsh. Then someone came running.

What he said, Papa didn't tell me. Only this — *"Someone came running, and I ran home."* From the field to the house. Papa ran.

He reached.

He saw Dadi.

In the courtyard. Near the handpump. The same place where she had gone to work that morning.

That morning, Dadi had bathed me. Put powder on me. Put kajal on me. Given me a toy. And then she had gone to work — in the courtyard, at the handpump.

Papa said nothing.

He just went quiet.

He stayed quiet.

For a long time.

Papa told me — Dadi had to be taken to Begusarai¹ by ambulance.

Papa was with her. Nani² was with her too.

Nani — Mummy's mother. Dadi's samdhan³. Two women whose relationship was only of relations, never close. But that day, she was with her.

The doctor at Begusarai saw Dadi. Then called Papa aside.

Said something.

Papa never told me what the doctor said. Only this — *"The doctor referred her to Patna⁴."*

But seeing Papa's face, Nani understood.

It was the last stage.

The ambulance moved again. The road to Patna. Begusarai to Patna — 2 hours. But that day, it was long.

Papa and Nani stayed silent. Dadi was between them.

No one said anything.

The ambulance was racing. But time wasn't stopping.
Before reaching Patna — on the way itself — Dadi passed away.
Her breath left.

Foam came from her mouth. White.
Papa told me.

Just that.

After that, he said nothing more.

Papa came alone.

With Dadi's body. Nani stayed there — she went to her own parents' home. Her duty was done.

Everyone in the house was crying.

Mummy.

Papa.

Sister.

Relatives.

Everyone.

But I wasn't crying.

I was 11 months old.

I didn't know anything.

I was beside Dadi.

Sleeping.

Someone had placed me there. Or I was there myself. I don't know.

Someone took a photo then.

In that photo, I was sleeping beside Dadi.

11 months old.

And she was cold.

I found that photo in 2019.

I was in 6th. I was looking for something in the house. I found that photo in an album.
I looked at it.
I didn't understand anything.
I put it back quietly.
And then in 2024, Mummy told me everything.
Then I remembered that photo.
Then I understood —
in that photo, I was beside Dadi.
And Dadi was cold at that time.
I was 11 months old.
I didn't know anything.

NOTES

- ¹ A city in Bihar, India
- ² Maternal grandmother
- ³ Co-mother-in-law — the mother of one's child's spouse
- ⁴ Capital of Bihar, India

CHAPTER THREE

A Changing Home

2010–2012



Days kept passing. And 2009 brought a lot of problems.

First, Mummy's second issue. Then, Dadi's death.

2010 — for me, or for my family — must have been better. That year, there was a wedding in the family. And Bua ji's son was born too, I think.

2011 was similar. When you shift to a new house, you have to visit old relatives for pooja and all. So everyone would call out my name from the road itself.

And I would secretly watch those people.

That year, my *Mundan*² happened — 4 May 2012. I obviously wasn't happy about it. My dear hair was gone.

In 2012, my first birthday was probably celebrated on 26 March. I had perhaps turned 4.

They say when new hair grows, the mind grows too. So after my *Mundan*, I got attached to *Anganwadi*³ — Aunty's school. There, I would count and eat soya beans.

I would stay there till the very end. And somehow, without even realizing it, I finished the Nursery syllabus.

"Swinging on the jhula⁴ has been a part of my childhood since the very beginning."

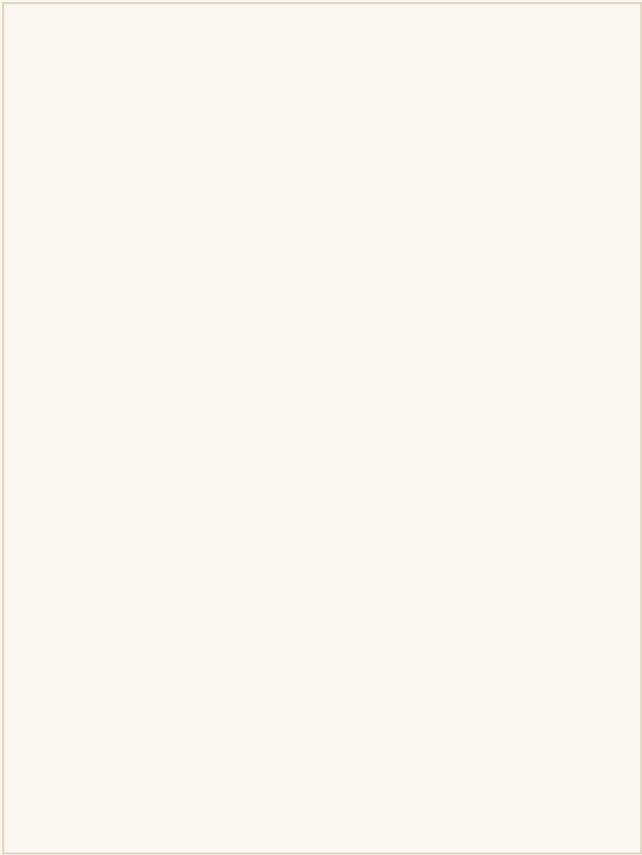


Fig. 3.1 – Fourth birthday, 2012



Home is not a place — it's the people who wait for you.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

- ¹ Father's sister (aunt)
- ² Hindu ritual of first head-shaving
- ³ Government-run rural pre-school in India
- ⁴ Swing

CHAPTER FOUR

First Steps into School

2013



Both my sisters were going to GBGS¹. So the fees were 300 — for both together.

So, in February 2013, on Saraswati Puja², my admission happened directly into **L.K.G** (Lower Kindergarten).

Because I had already completed the Nursery course — just by swinging on the jhula.

LKG Begins...

Name — Suraj Anand

School — Gautam Buddha Global School

Sanskar Nagar, Bandwar, Begusarai³

Motto — "ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय"

In the beginning of LKG, I would cry a lot. I would tell my sisters to come meet me during lunch break.

And in class, at the end, I would ask the other kids to let me pass.



The first step is always the hardest — and the most important.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH

**NOTES**

¹ Gautam Buddha Global School, Begusarai

² Festival of Goddess Saraswati

³ A city in Bihar, India

CHAPTER FIVE

A House Divided

2014–2016



2014 — I moved to UKG.

In 2015, I was in 1st Class. Mummy taught at Don Bosco Academy¹. Due to financial constraints, I started going with her to the Don Bosco Academy² branch — Cheria Bariyarpur, Begusarai³. Because it was free for me there.

I went there for only 3 months. The travel itself used to cause bone trouble. And we would reach home only by evening.

At that time, there was a dispute in our house. A property division happened — of land, belongings, everything.

Though our house was very big, and it was already a 2-sided house, so there was no problem.

Earlier, I used to live on the left side. Then I started living on the new right side.

But the financial condition kept getting worse.

In 2016, after 3 months, I continued again at GBGS⁴.

In 2016, I did not appear for the Term-2 exam of 1st Class. My health had deteriorated. I was unhealthy.

'An 8-year-old boy'

Friends' names: Abhilash, Ayush, Harsh.



Sometimes a family breaks, but love never truly leaves.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

¹ A Catholic school in India

² A Catholic school in India

CHAPTER SIX

An Unexpected Leap

2017



In 1st Class, I had many friends: Md. Nakib, Rajnish, Rupesh, Abhinav, Saurav (Komal), and many more. But...

By that time, these people left the school and went to another one. Because this was a small school, and teachers were decreasing.

Sandhya Miss. Puja Miss. Gunjan Sir. Jitender Sir. Chandan Sir.

The result hadn't come out yet. So my parents got me promoted from 1st Class. And since the school was my Chacha's, it happened easily.

I jumped from 1st to 3rd. Initially, it was tough — that's what I felt. But in Don Bosco School, I had already studied ICSE books for 3 months. So I recovered within a few days.

So there I was — 3rd Class. Going smoothly.

Nakib and Abhinav became my juniors. Then Rohit and Satyam.

Science was taught by Veena Ma'am — living things and all. Hindi by Sadhana Ma'am. English by Ekta Miss. Sanskrit too by Sadhana Ma'am. 3rd Class went smoothly.



Life jumps when you're not ready — that's how you grow.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

- ¹ Father's brother (uncle) — Subhash uncle

CHAPTER SEVEN

Earning a Name

2017



In 3rd Class, 8 seniors became my friends. From then on, they started calling me 'Suraj Bhaiya'.

And then — a fight broke out in our class. A random fight.

The boys had no value in that class.

The teacher scolded me. And Shitanshu too. My rank got spoiled. And Ganesh — he went to another school.

So from 3rd to 4th Class (State Board) — because of Chandan Sir — everyone changed. He made us memorize the names of state capitals.

I remember some things. So I'm writing this.



Respect is earned in silence, not announced in noise.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



CHAPTER EIGHT

The Will to Rise

2018



In 4th Class, I must have thought — why are my ranks coming like this? So I started studying. With Chanchal Sir.

Mummy got coaching arranged. But my crying superpower was very good. Whenever I didn't feel like doing any work, I would start crying.

Teachers (2018):

Gautam Sir — English

Sunil Sir — Math

Gautam Sir / Amrender Sir — SST

Mohit Sir — English

Bittu Sir — Computer

Manish Sir — Processing

The 4th Class result came out. My rank was 4th.

I had secured 4th. And literally, I felt bad that day.

I sat and thought — if I secure 1st in 5th Class, then in 5th, my rank will be 1st.

1st: Swati

2nd: Sanjana

3rd: Asmita

4th: Suraj Anand (A.K.A Ravi Raj)

Then I thought — no more following behind others. I have to push myself so far ahead, that others stay behind me.

During Holi¹ and all, there was fun. To sing, we would go to the playground, sit in a corner and listen. But friends wouldn't let us sit...



Rank is a number. The will to rise has no ceiling.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

- ¹ Festival of colors

CHAPTER NINE

A Dream Takes Shape

2018–2019



My Mummy joined GBGS¹ in 2018 itself. From then on, she taught Hindi in this school.

Time kept passing. And exams kept happening.

Our school had good "Sakhi" — current affairs and all. Everyone was very much into it.

That school was only up to 8th. But students could only reach up to 6th-7th. Because after that, they would leave. There were no teachers.

So according to that, we — the ones in 5th — became the seniors. So we 4 friends would go to conduct the assembly.

And a girls' group + 4-5 more girls would do the assembly.

Even in commanding, we had fights. "I'll do it" — "No, I'll do it"... Bla Bla Bla.

I participated in the whole function for the first time. And that too in 5th Class.

And at that time, whatever was my dream of becoming an Engineer — that dream was going to come true anyway.

This was the first time — on 15 August 2018 — I participated in a dance and also gave a speech.

My uncle (Director Sir) gifted me a Pen. And in the assembly, he asked every child: "*What will you become when you grow up?*"

Someone said Doctor. Someone said Police, Army, Astronaut, Scientist...

But I — Suraj Anand (Ravi Raj) — went up and said "**Engineer**".

Then Sir asked: "*Which one — Bridge Engineer or Computer Engineer?*"

And I went silent.

Because I didn't even know what it takes to become an engineer!



Dreams don't shout — they quietly take shape.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



CHAPTER TEN

A Tribute and a Farewell

2019



I just wanted to become an engineer because my Mummy ji¹ was an engineer.

Anyway. In March 2019, my 5th Class exam happened. But just before that — on 10 Feb 2019, Saraswati Puja — something special happened.

In between, in Nov 2018 itself, an EC Competition (Clean & Green School) exam happened on the 14th, at Don Bosco.

It was the first time I went from home with the school kids. With friends, I had fun.

When the result came out, I realized for the first time what a competition really was. My cutoff was 85/100.

Out of them, only 51 children were selected. And the highest marks were 96.

In the evening, the management called us and gave awards to everyone. Certificate, medal, and a GK Award.

I felt happy that for the first time I got a gift and so much respect. But I felt bad that the competition was of L.K.G. level — so how would I compete?

However, on 14 Feb 2019, the Pulwama attack² also happened. And the prize distribution was on the same day.

So I paid tribute to the CRPF³ Indian Forces. And then came back.

The final exam of Class 5th was of ICSE⁴ pattern. The result was supposed to come in the last week of March — on 31/03/2019.

On the first day of the class, 85%+ and second position was held by Sushil — who was my competitor.

My mood had changed. And I became diligent (hardworking) too.

My Mummy always thought well about me. And when she found out that I passed 5th Class, her happiness knew no bounds.

Since I had shifted schools, I made friends with everyone. Those who scored more than 80% were very few.

When the talk of our 8 mates came up — everyone left the school. Everyone got separated. Everyone started handling themselves.

What had to happen — started happening...



NOTES

- ¹ 'Ji' is a suffix of respect — Smt. Rajani Kumari
- ² Feb 14, 2019 — Kashmir terror attack
- ³ Central Reserve Police Force — India's largest paramilitary force
- ⁴ Indian Certificate of Secondary Education

CHAPTER ELEVEN

Process of Shifting

2019



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER TWELVE

Chapter Twelve

2020



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

Chapter Thirteen

2021



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Chapter Fourteen

2022



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

Chapter Fifteen

2023



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

Chapter Sixteen

2024



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

Chapter Seventeen

2025



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

Chapter Eighteen

2026



This chapter is being written. Coming soon.

The Story Behind the Story

I didn't plan to write a book. I started writing — one memory at a time. One evening. One cup of chai.

It began as a diary. Then it became a way to understand myself.

I wrote about my childhood because I wanted to remember it. I wrote about my struggles because I wanted to survive them. And I wrote about my dreams because I still believe in them.

This book is not the end. It is the beginning of a longer conversation — with myself, and with you.

— Ravi Raj Singh

About the Author



Ravi Raj Singh

AUTHOR

Ravi Raj Singh is a writer based in Patna, India. He has kept a personal diary since childhood, and began writing online around 2023–24.

"A Boy Who Never Thought" is his first book. It grew out of that habit. The book is written in both English and Hinglish, and remains in progress.

His writing focuses on ordinary lives, small moments, and the quiet ways a person grows.



Written in Patna, India

2026



Set in Playfair Display & Lora

Typeset by hand

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*An 18-year journey from 2008 to 2026.
From Bandwar, Begusarai to the dream
of becoming an Engineer.*

*A true story of loss, changing homes, first steps
into school, and the will to rise.*



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ravi Raj Singh is a self-taught learner and aspiring engineer from Patna, India.

This memoir recounts the journey of resilience, loss, and determination against all odds.



SCAN TO READ